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January 3, 1966
SUPERSEDING
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April 11, 1955

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FILING CABINETS, STEEL, CARD SIZE (FOR DESK USE)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. The steel filing cabinets covered by this specification are intended for use on top of desks or other items of office furniture, and are designed for limited quantities of active index card filing by single units or multiple units that interlock in vertical stacks. For extensive card filing, a vertical (upright) filing cabinet should be used.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Classes and sizes.* The filing cabinets covered by this specification shall be of the following classes and sizes as specified (see 6.1).

Class A—Single drawer.
- Size 1—For 5- by 3-inch cards.
- Size 2—For 6- by 4-inch cards.
- Size 3—For 8- by 5-inch cards.

Class B—Double drawer.
- Size 1—For 5- by 3-inch cards.
- Size 2—For 6- by 4-inch cards.
- Size 3—For 8- by 5-inch cards.
- Size 4—For 7-3/8- by 3-1/4-inch (tabulating machine) cards.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-490—Cleaning Methods and Pretreatment of Ferrous Surfaces for Organic Coatings.

PPP-C-20—Cabinets, Filing, Steel (Card and Tabulating Machine Size), Packaging, Packing and Marking of.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

Fed. Std. No. 595—Colors.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

FSC 7110

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-130—Identification Marking of U. S. Military Property.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 **Other publication.** The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

Steel Products Manual.

(Copies may be obtained from American Iron and Steel Institute, 150 East 42 St., New York, N.Y., 10017.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Preproduction sample.** Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), before production is commenced, a sample of the finished commodity, and each component part, shall be submitted or made ready for approval of the contracting officer or his authorized representative for inspection and tests to determine compliance with this specification. Approval of the preproduction sample authorizes the commencement of production, but does not relieve the contractor of responsibility for compliance with all other applicable provisions of this specification. Production units shall not vary from the approved preproduction sample in design or construction without written approval of the contracting officer.

3.2 **Materials.**

3.2.1 *Steel.* The steel sheets used in the fabrication of the cabinets shall be of commercial quality cold rolled or cold rolled oiled, either of which shall have a stretcher leveled standard of flatness as defined in Steel Products Manual; or hot rolled pickled and oiled sheets may be used for the drawer body, case bottom, compressor parts, and all structural members. Cold rolled steel shall be used for outside drawer front and case sides, tops and backs, and may be used throughout. The steel shall be bright, smooth, free of rust, scale, pits, scratches, laps, and buckles affecting strength or appearance and shall withstand the bend test specified in 4.3.1.

3.2.1.1 *Gages.* The gages for steel parts shall be the minimum specified in table I. The gage numbers are the Manufacturer's Standard Gage for steel sheets. The decimal equivalent shown for the sheet thickness is subject to the established tolerance or ordering limit.

TABLE I. *Gages of steel parts*

Parts	Gage number	Equivalent of sheet thickness, (inch)
Case sides, top, bottom and back	24	0.0239
Front partition	22	.0299
Drawer body (including inner wall of front)	24	.0239
Drawer guide channel	24	.0239
Compressor channel	20 (or 1/4" OD rod)	.0359
Compressor face	20	.0359
Compressor handle and bracket, not embossed	14	.0747
Compressor handle and bracket, embossed	20	.0359
Corner bracket	20	.0359
Extension bail — 1/2" wide	16	.0598

3.2.2 *Rubber.* Rubber for feet shall be natural or synthetic or a suitable combination thereof which will not mark a painted surface and is resistant to sliding.

3.2.3 *Hardware.*

3.2.3.1 *Face hardware.* The face hardware shall be satin finished anodized aluminum or brushed chromium on steel, die cast zinc, or bronze.

3.2.3.2 *Bolts, nuts, screws, and washers.* The bolts, nuts, screws, and washers shall

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be made rust resistant by means of cadmium or zinc plating.

3.2.4 *Finishing material.*

3.2.4.1 *Primer.* The primer, when used, shall be compatible with the finishing enamel used.

3.2.4.2 *Enamel.* Enamel shall be the manufacturer's commercial product except the color shall be as specified in 3.2.4.2.1.

3.2.4.2.1 *Color of finish.* The color of the finish shall be gray, color No. 26134 of Fed. Std. No. 595. Sample panels of the standard color are obtainable, without charge, from the Business Service Center, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D.C., 20406, or from the Business Service Center of the nearest GSA Regional Office.

3.3 **Construction.**

3.3.1 *Design.* The design of the cabinets shall be as shown in figure 1.

3.3.2 *Dimensions.* The overall outside dimensions of the cabinets, exclusive of hardware, shall be as shown in table II.

TABLE II. *Overall dimensions, (inches)*

	Card size	Height	Width	Depth
Class A:				
Size 1___	5 by 3	5-1/4	6-5/8	16
Size 2___	6 by 4	6-1/4	7-5/8	16
Size 3___	8 by 5	7-1/4	9-5/8	16
Class B:				
Size 1___	5 by 3	5-1/4	12-5/8	16
Size 2___	6 by 4	6-1/4	14-5/8	16
Size 3___	8 by 5	7-1/4	18-5/8	16
Size 4	7-3/8 by 3-1/4	5-1/4	17-3/8	16

3.3.2.1 *Tolerances.* The following plus or minus tolerances will be permitted in the overall dimensions: Width, 1/16 inch; height 1/8 inch; depth 1/16 inch.

3.3.3 *Spot welding.* Spot welds shall be not closer to the edge of either adjoining member than one-half the greatest dimension of the spot weld nor shall they be centered closer together than twice the greatest dimension. All depressed or protruding spot welds on the cabinet exterior shall be filled and sanded or ground smooth. Spot welds shall be centered not more than 3 inches apart.

3.3.4 *Cabinet case.* The components of the cabinet case shall be of the quality of steel specified in 3.2.1, and the steel gages specified in table I. The case shall be flanged, channeled, braced, and welded to house, support, and guide the drawers. Joints shall be fully and neatly closed. Flanges shall be not less than 1/2 inch wide. Width of channels shall permit the outside case dimensions to come within the permitted tolerance. Two stacking slots shall be punched in the top of each cabinet. The slots shall be 5/8 inch long by 5/64 inch wide and centered between the sides, beginning 5/8 inch and 15-3/8 inches from the front of the cabinet. Stacking lugs shall be 19/32 inch wide and of 16 gage (0.0598 inch) steel, formed 30° to the front, to interlock with the stacking slots and to prevent stacked cabinets from tipping when drawers are extended. Each case shall be equipped with four removable protecting feet of the material specified in 3.2.2. The feet shall extend below the stacking lugs by at least 1/16 inch.

3.3.5 *Drawers.* The drawers shall be constructed of the quality of steel specified in 3.2.1, and the steel gages specified in table I, and shall be designed to adequately hold and protect the cards. The front shall be of double wall construction. The drawer shall be equipped with a bail as shown in figure 1, or a closed back may be furnished, either of which shall be formed to strengthen the drawer sides and bottom. The bail or back shall prevent removal of the drawer from the case unless the drawer front is lifted. If a closed back is furnished, it shall have a smoothly finished handhole not less than 3-1/2 inches wide by 1 inch high. The top of the handhole shall consist of the steel folded back on itself forming a double thickness or a securely attached steel rod of sufficient thickness to prevent its

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bending or injury to hands when lifting a fully loaded drawer. All surfaces around the handhole shall be smoothly finished. Drawer sides shall have rolled edges. The drawers shall be assembled by means of welding. All exposed sharp edges and surfaces shall be eliminated by grinding.

3.3.6 *Compressors.* The compressor components shall be of the quality of steel specified in 3.2.1, and the steel gages specified in table I. It shall be spring activated, the face of which shall be the approximate size of the card the drawer is designed to hold. The face shall be finished by a method which completely eliminates rough surfaces. The compressor shall operate on a rod or in a channel.

3.3.7 *Label holder and drawer pull.* The label holder and drawer pull shall be formed from one piece of one of the materials specified in 3.2.3.1. The material used shall be not less than 0.028 inch thick. The pull shall be smoothly formed and finished to eliminate all sharp edges or surfaces. The label holder shall hold, without binding, label cards at least 1-1/8 inches high by 2-1/2 inches wide. The label holder and pull shall have threaded studs and shall be attached to the drawer front by solid nuts and lockwashers. Fastenings used shall not penetrate the inside drawer front.

3.4 **Pretreatment and finishing.**

3.4.1 *Pretreatment.* All exterior and interior unplated ferrous metal surfaces shall be cleaned and surface preparation processed in accordance with any of the methods specified in TT-C-490.

3.4.2 *Priming.* Except as otherwise specified herein, all surfaces treated as specified in 3.4.1 shall be coated with primer as specified in 3.2.4.1.

3.4.3 *Enameling.* All primed surfaces shall be coated with enamel as specified in 3.2.4.2, and baked in accordance with the enamel manufacturer's direction. Total dry film thickness of enamel and primer shall be not less than 1.4 mils on exterior surface and not less than 0.6 mil on interior surfaces. Primer may be omitted from any surface prepared for painting in accordance with type I or II of TT-C-490, provided the dry enamel film thickness is not less than 1.0 mil on exterior surfaces and not less than 0.6 mil on interior surfaces. The finish shall level out to produce smooth, uniform, exposed surfaces without runs, wrinkles, grits, areas of thin film or no film, and separation of color. Finish panels shall withstand the test specified in 4.3.2.

3.5 **Identification marking.** Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), each cabinet shall be inconspicuously marked in a plain, permanent and legible manner, with the Federal Stock Number, contract number, and the manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined. When specified (see 6.1), identification marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.6 **Workmanship.** The workmanship shall be of a quality to produce a serviceable and neat item of office furniture to withstand hard daily usage, and the following features shall be stressed: folding or bending to eliminate sharp exposed edges, smooth straight bending of channels and flanges, strength of welding and bracing, accuracy of moving parts, stacking slots and lugs, and the placing of drawer stops. Cabinets shall be free of any defects which affect their appearance or which might impair serviceability. There shall be no sharp exposed edges or surfaces. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the acceptable quality level (AQL) specified herein.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Inspection responsibility. The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable

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to the Government as specified (see 6.1). The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspection set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 **Sampling for inspection and acceptance.** Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105 except where otherwise indicated herein.

4.2.1 *Component and material inspection.* In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, tested and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified, or if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2.2 *End item inspection.*

4.2.2.1 *Visual examination.* Examination of the cabinets shall be in accordance with the classification of defects specified in table III. The lot size shall be expressed in units of cabinets for the purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit for this examination shall be one completely fabricated cabinet of each class and size.

TABLE III. *Classification of end item defects*

Examine	Defects	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Enamel finish	Indication of rust undercoating	X	
	Poor adhesion, i.e. blistered, checking, or peeling		X
	Tacky (not dry to touch)		X
	Color separation, stain, or not smooth and uniform		X
	Runs, sags, or foreign matter in coating		X
	Scratch through to base metal or bare spots	X	
Metallic coatings	Abrasion or area of thin coating		X
	Wrong kind		X
	Poor adhesion, i.e., blistered, peeling, stained, or discolored		X
Workmanship and construction	Any part missing	X	
	Broken, punctured, or cracked parts	X	
	Dent up to and including 1/2 inch long or 1/8 inch deep and not affecting appearance or serviceability		X
	Dent affecting appearance or serviceability or any dent over 1/2 inch long or 1/8 inch deep	X	
	Malformed, damaged, buckled, or warped parts affecting appearance		X
	Malformed, damaged, buckled, or warped parts affecting serviceability	X	
	Scratches, roughness, etc., visible through enamel finish		X
Welds	Omitted where specified (except spot welds)	X	
	More than one spot weld missing at any one joint	X	
	One spot weld missing at any one joint		X
	Not fused	X	
	Burnt through	X	
	Cracked or fractured	X	
	Not smooth (exposed welds)		X
	Flash or spatter not removed (exposed welds)		X
	Pitted		X
	Not complete		X
Identification marking	Missing	X	
	Defective, i.e., illegible, incorrect or wrong location		X

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4.2.2.2 *Dimensional examination.* Inspection will be made of cabinets for compliance with dimensions specified (including thickness of metal). Any deviation therefrom shall constitute a defect.

4.2.3 *Inspection of preparation for delivery.* An inspection shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements comply with section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table IV. For examination of contents, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected just prior to the closing operations. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot.

TABLE IV. *Classification of preparation for delivery defects*

Examine	Defect
Markings (exterior and interior containers)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible, of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of compenets such as: Incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, bulging or distortion of containers, inadequate stapling.

4.2.4 *Inspection levels and AQL's.* The inspection level and the AQL's expressed in defects per 100 units shall be as follows:

For examination in	Inspection level	AQL's	
		Major	Minor
Table III	II	4.0	6.5
4.2.2.2 (1 class)	S-4	—	4.0
Table IV (1 class)	S-2	—	4.0

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Bend test for steel sheets.* The steel sheets used shall withstand 180° of bend at room temperature with and across the grain without showing any crystallization, cracks, or fractures on the outside of the bend. A slight granulation of the surface at the point of greatest deformation in the bend shall not be cause for rejection.

4.3.2 *Finish test.* A panel prepared in accordance with 3.4 shall be bent at room temperature around a 1/4 inch rod to 180°, without evidence of cracking, flaking, or loss of adhesion.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement, the definitions and application of levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102).

5.1 **Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking.** Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking shall be level A, B, or C in accordance with PPP-C-20. The level of protection shall be as specified (see 6.1).

6. NOTES

6.1 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Classes and sizes required (1.2.1).

(*c*) If preproduction sample requirement is waived (3.1).

(*d*) If special identification marking is required (3.5).

(*e*) Inspection record details (4.1).

(*f*) Level of packaging and packing required (5.1).

6.2 **Standard pack, civil agencies.** The standard pack for civil agencies shall be as specified in 5.1.

6.3 Federal specifications do not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc. of the commodities indicated by the titles of the

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specifications, or all of those commercially available, but are intended to cover those commodities generally procured by the Federal Government.

6.4 **Transportation descriptions.** Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Cabinets (filing), not otherwise indexed by names, steel, setup with solid walls less than 1 inch thick.

Carload minimum weights:

In cars 40 ft. 9 in. or less in length, inside measurements: 10,000, 12,000, 15,000, 18,000, 22,000, and 30,000 pounds.

In cars exceeding 40 ft. 9 in. in length, inside measurements: 16,000, 18,000, 21,000, 24,000, 30,000, and 40,000 pounds.

Motor:

Cabinets (filing), not otherwise indexed, steel, setup with solid walls, less than 1 inch thick.

Truckload minimum weights:

10,000, 12,000, 15,000, 18,000, 22,000, and 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

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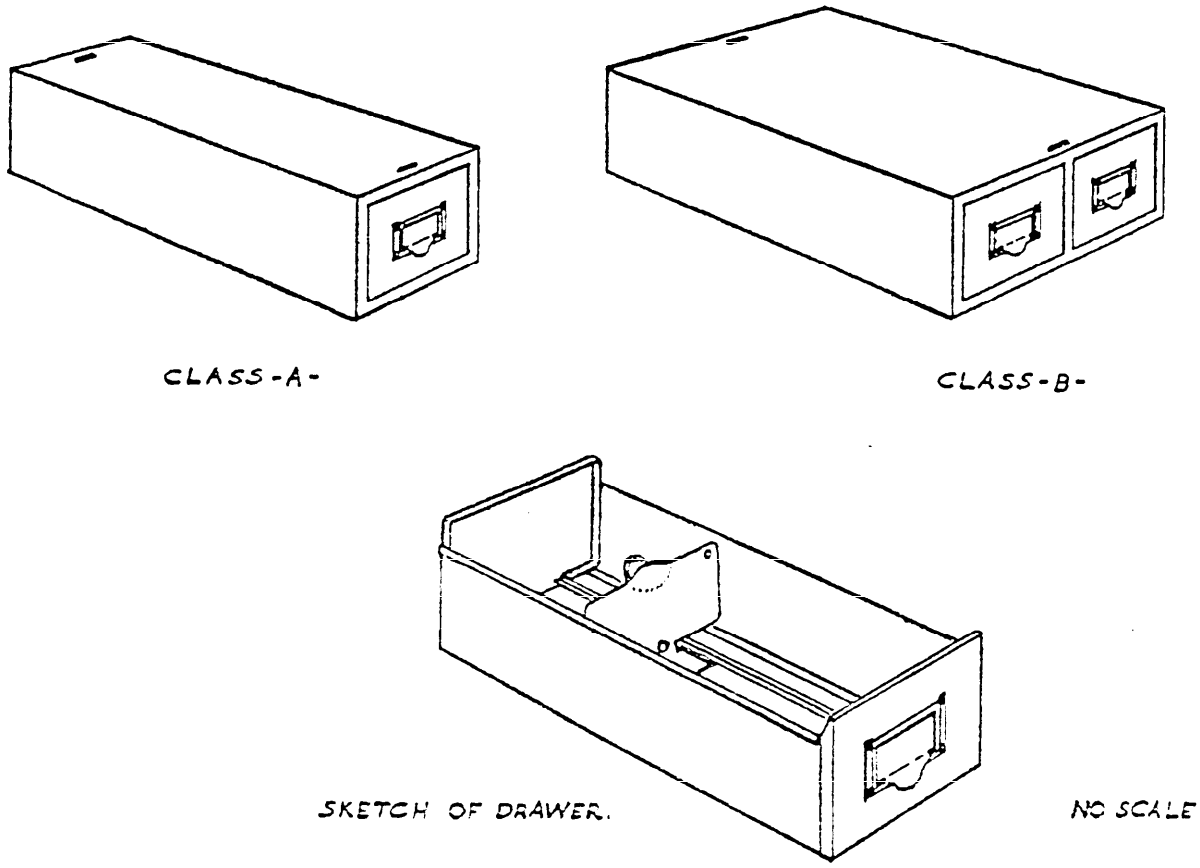


FIGURE 1. Filing cabinets, steel, card size.

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